

Fig 2.3 Stages of foetal growth

pregnancy. The incidence of anaemia, signs and symptoms of B complex vitamin deficiency such as angular stomatitis, glossitis, tingling and numbness, burning feet are common among low socio economic group. Serum levels of many nutrients such as serum iron, folic acid, vitamin B12, riboflavin, vitamin A and bone density are significantly lower in women from low income group as compared to the well to do women.

c) Maternal mortality

Anaemia, heavy bleeding and toxaemia seems to contribute to nearly 30 - 40 % of maternal death, indicating that maternal malnutrition is a major determinant of high maternal mortality.

d) Placental function

There is an impairment in placental function due to maternal malnutrition. Earlier opinion that placenta could function normally at the expenses of maternal resources is now been a question.

Activity : 1

Conduct a survey among pregnant women and find out weight gain during trimesters.

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